

Lumexa — Digital Independence Path

Course 18, Lesson 2: Build Your Professional Profile

What You're Doing Today (and Why)

Last lesson, you figured out your values, goals, and a short brand statement. Today you're turning that into an actual professional profile — the thing a teacher, mentor, future employer, or collaborator sees when they look you up.

You'll be in one of two paths today:

- **Path A — LinkedIn:** You'll write a LinkedIn headline, About section, and one Experience/Education entry.
- **Path B — Portfolio-First:** You'll write the same content as a "presence page" — an About/intro section added to your Course 16 portfolio site.

Both paths matter equally. LinkedIn has a minimum age requirement, so not everyone in class will use it today — that's completely normal and not a downgrade. A well-written personal site does the exact same job: it tells people, clearly and honestly, what you can do.

The one rule for both paths: **everything you write has to be true.** No invented job titles, no made-up years of experience, no skills you can't actually demonstrate. Specific and true beats impressive and vague — every single time.

Key Terms

Term	Definition
Headline	A one-line summary (under a LinkedIn photo, or at the top of a portfolio page) that says what you do and where you're headed — in about 8 seconds of reading.
About section	A short, 4-part written introduction that explains who you are, what you can actually do, what you're working toward, and how someone can connect with you.
Presence page	The portfolio-site equivalent of a LinkedIn profile — usually your homepage or "About" page, combining an intro/About section with your existing project gallery from Course 16.

The Headline Formula

[What you do / are learning] + [specific tool, skill, or focus area] + [what you're curious about or working toward]

This works exactly the same whether it's a LinkedIn headline or the top line of your portfolio site.

Weak example: "10th grade student" **Strong example:** "Aspiring web developer building projects in JavaScript — currently exploring how design and code work together."

Notice the strong version names a real skill and a real direction. It doesn't rely on your grade, age, or title to sound credible — it relies on specifics.

The About-Section Formula

Four short paragraphs, in this order:

1. **Who you are** — 1–2 grounded sentences.
2. **What you can actually do** — 2–3 sentences about real things: a project you built, a class you took, a skill you've practiced. Nothing invented.
3. **What you're curious about or working toward** — shows direction, doesn't overclaim.
4. **How to connect / what you're open to** — an invitation, or a link to your portfolio.

Worked Example — Both Paths (Fictional Student: Sam Okafor, 17)

Sam has completed Lumexa Courses 1–17, built a weather-tracking app (Course 12), has a live portfolio site (Course 16), and volunteers teaching Scratch to younger kids.

Path A — LinkedIn Version

Headline:

Aspiring software developer building real projects in Python and JavaScript — currently exploring data visualization and teaching coding basics to younger students.

About section:

I'm a high school student who's spent the last year learning to build software that actually works, not just tutorials I follow along with.

I've built a weather-tracking web app that pulls live data and displays it with custom charts, and a personal portfolio site to showcase my projects. I'm comfortable with Python and JavaScript fundamentals, and I'm learning how to write cleaner, more readable code as my projects get bigger.

Right now I'm curious about data visualization and how software can make information easier to understand at a glance. I'd like to keep building projects that solve small, real problems.

I also volunteer teaching basic coding (Scratch) to younger kids at my community center, which has taught me a lot about explaining ideas clearly. Open to connecting with other student developers and mentors in software.

Experience entry:

Volunteer Coding Instructor — [Community Center Name] Teach introductory Scratch programming concepts to students ages 8–11 in weekly small-group sessions; developed simplified explanations of loops and conditionals for a younger audience.

Path B — Portfolio Presence-Page Version

Same headline. Same About section, word for word — pasted as the intro/About section of the portfolio homepage, sitting just above the project gallery. Optionally, a simple Canva-designed header (photo or graphic + name + headline) sits above the text as a visual banner. The volunteer teaching role is added as a short line either inside the About text or as its own small "Experience" card on the site, using the exact same honest wording as the LinkedIn version above.

The takeaway: the writing doesn't change based on the platform. Only the container does.

Step-by-Step Activity

1. Open your Google Doc worksheet (shared by your instructor).
 2. **Draft your headline** using the formula above. Read it out loud — does it sound like you, or like a template?
 3. **Draft your About section**, paragraph by paragraph, using the 4-part formula. For paragraph 2, only include things you could explain live if someone asked you about them right now.
 4. **Path A:** Draft one Experience or Education entry describing a real project, class, or volunteer role. Use an accurate title — don't invent a position that doesn't exist. **Path B:** Confirm (or add) one project/experience entry on your site that uses the same honest, specific language.
 5. Compare your draft to your Course 16 bio/brand statement. Does the tone and focus match? If not, decide which version is more accurate and adjust.
 6. Raise your hand (or flag in chat) for an instructor check before you publish or save live.
 7. **Path A:** Paste your reviewed headline and About section into LinkedIn. **Path B:** Add your reviewed About section to your portfolio site, optionally with a Canva header graphic.
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Knowledge Checks

1. What are the four parts of the About-section formula, in order?

2. True or False: A strong headline should just state your job title or grade level.
 3. Why does the headline formula ask for a *specific* skill or tool instead of a general subject area (like "technology")?
 4. A student writes: "I'm an expert in five programming languages." What's wrong with this claim, and how could it be rewritten honestly?
 5. What is a "presence page," and how is it similar to a LinkedIn profile?
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Reflection Prompts

1. Which part of your About section was hardest to write honestly — the "what you can do" part, or the "what you're working toward" part? Why?
 2. Read your headline out loud to yourself. Does it sound like something you'd actually say about yourself to a stranger? What would you change?
 3. If you're in the Portfolio-First path: how did it feel to build this presence page instead of a LinkedIn profile? If you're in the LinkedIn path: what surprised you about writing for a professional platform?
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Submission Instructions

- Save your completed Google Doc worksheet (headline + About section + Experience/Education draft) — this is your record even after you publish.
- **Path A:** Once your instructor approves your draft, publish it to your LinkedIn headline and About fields, and add your Experience/Education entry.
- **Path B:** Once your instructor approves your draft, add it to your live portfolio site as your About/intro section.
- Submit the link to your finished profile (LinkedIn URL or portfolio URL) through your Lumexa student dashboard before the next class session.